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Ukraine conflict: An overview

1	**A special military operation**	**2**
2	**Key points in the conflict**	**3**
2.1	Russian annexation of territory	3
2.2	Ukraine's counteroffensives in 2022 and 2023	4
2.3	Ukrainian success in the Black Sea	5
2.4	Reshuffle of Ukraine's military leaders in 2024	6
2.5	Russian tactical gains in eastern Ukraine	6
2.6	Allegations of Russian chemical weapons use	7
2.7	Ukrainian offensive into Russia's Kursk region	8
2.8	North Korean support for Russia	9
2.9	Russia's economy is placed on a war footing	10
3	**International reaction**	**11**
4	**Efforts to secure a ceasefire and peace agreement**	**12**

Russia's invasion of Ukraine marked its three-year anniversary on 24 February 2025.

Prior to the invasion, there had already been eight years of conflict in eastern Ukraine between Ukrainian Government forces and Russian-backed separatists.

1 A special military operation

On 21 February 2022, President Putin officially recognised the self-declared independence of the Donetsk People's Republic (DPR) and Luhansk People's Republic (LPR), the regions of eastern Ukraine (the Donbas) that have been under the control of Russian-backed separatist forces since 2014 (a map of Ukraine depicting its regions and major cities is supplied on page 14).[1] Treaties of Friendship, Cooperation and Mutual Assistance were subsequently signed with the leaders of those regions and Russian forces were deployed under the guise of peacekeeping operations.

Three days later, on 24 February, President Putin announced that Russia, acting in self-defence and in accordance with the Treaties of Friendship, was launching a special military operation in Ukraine. Russian forces crossed into the country from Belarus in the north, Russia in the east and Crimea in the south.

The purpose of the operation, he said, was to protect the people of the Donbas from "humiliation and genocide perpetrated by the Kiev regime" and to "demilitarise and de-nazify Ukraine".[2] The Kremlin denied, however, that it was planning to occupy Ukrainian territory or "to impose anything on anyone by force".[3]

The move came after months of diplomacy aimed at averting a crisis and despite Russian insistence that it had no plans to invade Ukraine. The Kremlin had previously said that its build-up of forces on Ukraine's borders was in response to provocative actions by NATO.[4]

1 President of Russia, Signing of documents recognising Donetsk and Lugansk People's Republics, 21 February 2022
2 Address by the President of the Russian Federation, 24 February 2022
3 Address by the President of the Russian Federation, 24 February 2022
4 The build up to the invasion of Ukraine is examined in greater detail in House of Commons Library briefing, Ukraine: Russia's "red line", February 2022

2 Key points in the conflict

After failing to take Kyiv in the first few months of the conflict, Russian forces have largely focused on eastern and southern Ukraine, with the aim of taking full control of the Donbas region and establishing, and sustaining, a land corridor through Kherson and Zaporizhzhia Oblasts, to Crimea in the south.

However, Russian forces have also targeted towns and cities and critical civilian national infrastructure, in particular energy networks, across the whole country. In January 2023 former EU High Representative, Josep Borrell, called the deliberate targeting of civilians and critical infrastructure a war crime.[5]

In the conduct of its military campaign Russian soldiers have been widely accused of war crimes, allegations that the Kremlin has also levelled at the Ukrainian government.

Since the end of February 2022, the UN Refugee Agency estimates that millions of refugees have fled Ukraine.

2.1 Russian annexation of territory

At the end of September 2022, Russian-backed authorities in Donetsk, Luhansk, Kherson and Zaporizhzhia called urgent referendums on joining Russia, even though those regions were not totally under Russian control.

According to the Kremlin the four occupied regions voted overwhelmingly in support of accession to the Russian Federation. In a speech on 30 September 2022, President Putin announced Russia's intention to annex those regions and recognise, and defend, them as part of the Russian Federation.

Those treaties of accession were signed into Russian law in early October 2022.[6]

Despite Russian attempts at annexation, all four regions are still not entirely under Russian control.[7]

5 EU External Action Service, Press release, 6 January 2023

6 The impact of Russia's attempt to annex territory is examined in greater detail in House of Commons Library briefings, Implications of the Russian-backed referendums in Ukraine, October 2022 and The UN General Assembly condemns Russia: But what can it actually do?, October 2022

7 See institute for the Study of War, Interactive map: Russia's invasion of Ukraine

2.2 Ukraine's counteroffensives in 2022 and 2023

Over the course of 2022, Ukraine, with military assistance from its allies and partners, conducted a major counteroffensive. Ukrainian forces liberated significant territory in the northeast and east of the country, including the towns of Izium, Kupiansk and Lyman. In the south, Ukrainian forces retook key towns and villages in Kherson, north of the Dnipro River.

In response, on 21 September 2022 Russia declared a partial mobilisation of up to 300,000 reserve forces and committed to defending the territorial integrity of Russia and the protection of people in the occupied regions in Ukraine which President Putin has said will be with Russia forever.[8]

Russia fortified defences along its front lines in the south and east of the country,[9] although on 9 November 2022 announced its intention to withdraw from the city of Kherson, the only regional capital it had captured since February 2022.[10] The wider Kherson region, to the south of the Dnipro River, remained in Russian hands.

The 2023 summer offensive

On the back of that initial success, President Zelenskyy vowed to continue the counteroffensive and reclaim all of Ukraine's sovereign territory, including Crimea which Russia annexed in 2014.[11]

Comprehensive military assistance has been provided by Ukraine's allies and partners, with the aim of helping Ukraine defend its sovereign territory, assist its counteroffensive and to reclaim the territory under Russian occupation that is within Ukraine's internationally recognised borders.[12]

Ukraine launched its counteroffensive in early June 2023. However, deeply entrenched Russian positions to the south of the Dnipro River in Kherson and Zaporizhzhia Oblasts made progress difficult and slow.[13] Going into the winter of 2023, Ukraine's counteroffensive had not achieved as much as some had hoped, with many talking of a "stalemate" in the conflict.[14]

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8 President of Russia, Signing on Treaties on Accession, 30 September 2022

9 Institute for the Study of War, Russian Offensive Campaign Assessments

10 "Kherson: Russia to withdraw troops from key Ukrainian city", BBC News, 9 November 2022

11 President of Ukraine, Address by President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, 30 September 2022

12 Western military assistance to Ukraine is examined in greater detail in Library research briefing, Military assistance to Ukraine since the Russian invasion

13 "Ukraine's counteroffensive hasn't met expectations: here's why progress has been slow", CNN, 4 July 2023

14 Including Ukraine's then Commander-in-Chief General Valery Zaluzhny (see "Ukraine's Commander in Chief on the breakthrough he needs to beat Russia", The Economist, 1 November 2023), who was

2.3 Ukrainian success in the Black Sea

Despite the lack of success in the ground counteroffensive, Ukraine has however made gains elsewhere, most notably in the Black Sea.

Crimea was used as a staging ground for Russia's invasion of Ukraine in February 2022 and has been central to resupplying Russian forces that have taken control of southern Ukraine and in imposing a blockade of Ukrainian ports and shipping routes. In July 2023 Russia also withdrew from the Black Sea Grain Initiative (PDF) which had allowed for the safe shipment of Ukrainian and Russian grain and related foodstuffs and fertilisers through the Black Sea to reach global markets, and declared any shipping in the Black Sea travelling to Ukrainian ports to be legitimate military targets.[15]

Russia's dominance over the region has decreased, however, as Ukraine successfully conducted a military campaign against Russian military assets in and around Crimea. Strikes on Russia's fleet, Black Sea Fleet Headquarters, command and control centres and Russian air bases in Crimea, along with longer term targeting of infrastructure such as the Kerch bridge and Russia's air defence network, allowed Ukraine to increase its freedom of manoeuvre in the region.[16] In early August 2023 Ukraine declared the waters around Russia's Black Sea ports a "war risk area"[17] and successfully established a maritime corridor in the western Black Sea through which it has been transporting grain and other goods.[18] In response Russia moved a significant proportion of its fleet to Russian naval bases further east in the Black Sea. In October 2023, Russia also announced it would establish a new naval base in the Georgian breakaway region of Abkhazia,[19] a move that the Georgian Foreign Ministry called a "gross violation of the sovereignty and territorial integrity of Georgia".[20]

subsequently rebuked by President Zelenskyy. See also Ivo Daalder, "Stalemate best describes the state of war in Ukraine", Politico, 27 November 2023; "Why Ukraine's stalemate will likely last another year", Time, 16 November 2023; Shashank Joshi, "The war in Ukraine may be heading for a stalemate", The Economist, 13 November 2023.

15 Statement of the Russian Ministry of Defence, 19 July 2023

16 Institute for the Study of War, Russian offensive campaign assessment, 14 February 2024

17 "Russia risks war with NATO in Black Sea, former top commander in Europe warns", Politico, 16 August 2023

18 Ukraine Ministry for Restoration, Press release, 16 August 2023

19 Russia already maintains a permanent military base of approximately 4,000 personnel at Gudauta on the Black Sea coast of Abkhazia. The OSCE, UK, EU and NATO continue to call for the withdrawal of Russian forces from Georgian territory (OSCE Parliamentary Assembly, Vancouver Declaration (PDF), July 2023; HC Deb 27 April 2023, c1026; NATO, Relations with Georgia (accessed 29 November 2023) and EU External Action Service, Press statement, 6 October 2023)

20 Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Georgia, Press release, 5 October 2023

2.4 Reshuffle of Ukraine's military leaders in 2024

In early February 2024, President Zelenskyy dismissed the Commander in Chief of Ukraine's armed forces, General Valery Zaluzhny.

Reports of divisions between President Zelenskyy and General Zaluzhny over strategy and the level of military progress being achieved had been circulating since the start of the Russian invasion,[21] and in November 2023 President Zelenskyy's office publicly rebuked Zaluzhny for saying that the Ukraine conflict was at a stalemate.[22] Zelenskyy also fired the Head of Ukraine's Special Forces.[23]

The dismissal of General Zaluzhny was part of a reset of the Ukrainian military command that President Zelenskyy hoped would change the trajectory of the conflict. He called for a "united approach across the whole frontline and a new vision for the war, mobilization and recruitment".[24] General Zaluzhny was replaced by Colonel General Oleksandr Syrsky. Zaluzhny has since been appointed as Ambassador to the UK.

2.5 Russian tactical gains in eastern Ukraine

Delays in Ukrainian military assistance from allies in the first half of 2024, in particular from the United States, were considered to have given Russia the opportunity to make slow, but steady, tactical gains along the frontline in eastern Ukraine.[25] Since February 2024 Ukraine has withdrawn its forces from several key positions in the Donetsk region, including the strategic towns of Avdiivka and Chasiv Yar, and established defensive lines further west. In May 2024, Russia also opened up a new front in northeastern Ukraine close to Ukraine's second city of Kharkiv. Despite initial concerns of a possible attack on the city as part of a wider Russian offensive, Russia said its intention was to create a "buffer zone" between Russian and Ukrainian forces.[26]

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21 "Zelenskiy dismisses idea of rift with army chief but wants more 'concrete' gains", Reuters, 19 December 2023 and "Zelensky claims 'working relationship' with Ukraine's top commander but rift rumours persist", The Independent, 20 December 2023

22 "Zelenskiy denies Ukrainian general's claim war is at stalemate", The Guardian, 5 November 2023

23 "Volodomyr Zelenskyy calls for discipline as cracks emerge in Kyiv's unity", Financial Times, 7 November 2023

24 "Will Zelenskyy's new Commander-in-Chief change Ukraine's fortunes on the battlefield?", Chatham House Expert Commentary, 12 February 2024

25 The debates over continued military assistance are examined in Library research briefing, Military assistance to Ukraine since the Russian invasion

26 "Putin says Russia wants a buffer zone in Ukraine's Kharkiv but has no plans to capture the city", Associated Press, 17 May 2024

Russia has also capitalised on Ukraine's shortage of air defence capability and conducted sustained attacks against Ukraine's population centres, energy infrastructure and industrial and military facilities.[27]

The influx of new Western military aid to the frontline was considered crucial to Ukraine's ability to stabilise its defensive lines in eastern Ukraine and halt Russia's momentum.[28]

Russia has however continued to make steady gains along the frontline, although that progress has come at a cost.[29] At the end of April 2025, Russia was estimated to have suffered 790,000 casualties (killed or injured) since the start of the conflict in February 2022.[30] As of January 2025, Ukraine is estimated to have suffered 400,000 casualties.[31]

2.6 Allegations of Russian chemical weapons use

At the beginning of the conflict there were concerns that Russia could resort to the use of chemical weapons in Ukraine in order to achieve its objectives more quickly.

More than two years into the conflict, the United States announced on 1 May 2024 that it considered Russia to be in contravention of its obligations under the Chemical Weapons Convention (CWC), to which it has been a State Party since 1997. The US specifically accused Russia of using the chemical weapon Chloropicrin against Ukrainian soldiers, in addition to using riot control agents as a method of warfare, which is also prohibited under the CWC.

The US State Department suggested that the use of such chemicals was "not an isolated incident" and was possibly driven by Russia's desire to make rapid gains on the battlefield (see above). In response, the US announced sanctions against Russian military personnel, several Russian state institutions and Russian companies which support those organisations.[32]

Russia denied the allegations which Kremlin spokesperson Dmitry Peskov said were "absolutely unfounded". He said that "Russia has been and remains committed to its obligations under international law in this area".[33]

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27 See also Institute for the Study of War, Russian offensive campaign assessment, 8 May 2024

28 Institute for the Study of War, Russian offensive campaign assessment, 3 July 2024. The new packages of assistance that have been announced by the US and other allies is set out in Library research briefing, Military assistance to Ukraine since the Russian invasion.

29 Institute for the Study of War, Interactive map: Russia's invasion of Ukraine

30 Harvard Kennedy School, Russia Matters: Russia-Ukraine Report Card, 20 August 2025

31 As above

32 US Department of State, Imposing new measures on Russia for its full-scale war and use of chemical weapons against Ukraine, 1 May 2024

33 "Russia denies US accusation it violated chemical weapons ban in Ukraine", SWI, 2 May 2024

Allegations of chemical weapons use by Russia on the ground in Ukraine continue, however. In July 2025, German and Dutch intelligence agencies said that the use of banned chemical agents by Russia in Ukraine was "widespread".[34] In response, the UK imposed sanctions on two individuals and one organisation for "engaging in, providing support for, or promoting prohibited activity related to chemical weapons".[35] EU sanctions relating to chemical weapons use in Ukraine had also been imposed in May 2025.[36] Ukraine has called on the Organisation for the Prohibition of Chemical Weapons (OPCW), which monitors and enforces the CWC, to launch an investigation.[37]

2.7 Ukrainian offensive into Russia's Kursk region

In August 2024, Ukraine's armed forces launched a surprise cross-border offensive into Russian territory, forcing hundreds of thousands of residents to flee. Equipped with armoured vehicles and tanks, Ukrainian forces penetrated Russian defensive lines and advanced up to 30km into the Kursk Oblast.[38]

President Zelenskyy said that Ukraine was not looking to occupy territory, but to create a buffer zone between Ukraine and Russian forces and the hope was for the offensive to pressure President Putin into peace negotiations.[39]

Since Ukraine launched its offensive in Kursk, Russia's own military offensive in eastern Ukraine has, however, shown no signs of diminishing. Neither has it pressured Russia into negotiations. Indeed, in August 2024 the Russian Foreign Ministry labelled the Kursk offensive a terrorist operation and said that it justified "the relevance of the goals and objectives of the special military operation for the denazification and demilitarisation of Ukraine".[40]

Russian forces seeking to repel the Ukrainian incursion in Kursk have been supported by North Korean soldiers (see below).

In early February 2025, President Zelenskyy offered to exchange Ukrainian-held territory in Kursk for Russian-occupied territory in Ukraine.[41] That idea was rejected by the Kremlin which said it would never discuss exchanging

34 BND, Joint statement: Russia increases its use of chemical weapons in Ukraine, 4 July 2025
35 Office of Financial Sanctions Implementation, Financial Sanctions Notice (PDF), 7 July 2025
36 Council of the European Union, Press release, 20 May 2025
37 Reuters, "Ukraine urges investigation into alleged Russian chemical weapons use", 8 July 2025
38 "Ukraine in maps: Tracking the war with Russia", BBC News, 22 August 2024
39 President of Ukraine, Address by the President, 13 August 2024; Address by the President, 7 August 2024
40 Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Russian Federation, Press comment, 11 August 2024 and Press comment, 14 August 2024
41 "Zelenskyy: Europe cannot guarantee Ukraine's security without America", The Guardian, 11 February 2025

territory and that Ukrainian forces in Kursk would either be destroyed or "pushed out".[42]

By the end of April 2025, Ukrainian forces had largely been withdrawn, or expelled, from the region. On 26 April Russia declared the region to have been liberated.[43] There continues to be some dispute, however, over the status of several border towns, with Ukraine estimated, as of August 2025, to hold approximately four square miles of Russian territory.[44] President Zelenskyy had previously expressed hope that holding Russian territory would provide leverage and strengthen Ukraine's hand in any subsequent peace negotiations (see below).[45]

2.8 North Korean support for Russia

Since the end of November 2023 North Korea has been providing Russia with military support for its invasion of Ukraine. Initially focused on the provision of munitions and ballistic missiles,[46] in early October 2024 government officials in Ukraine and South Korea said that North Korean military personnel were also on the ground in Ukraine supporting Russia with missile launches against Ukrainian targets.[47] That assessment was not shared at the time by allies.

Estimates varied, but up to 12,000 North Korean soldiers (including 500 officers and three army generals) were also reported to be in Russia.[48] While many were reported to be training for possible future deployments alongside the Russian military, several thousand were deployed to the Kursk Oblast.[49]

In a report on 15 October 2024, the Institute for the Study of War (ISW) assessed that "the Kremlin is likely leveraging the recent June 2024 Russia-North Korea comprehensive strategic partnership agreement", and in

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42 "Moscow rejects territory swap in potential Ukraine peace deal", The Moscow Times, 12 February 2025

43 President of Russia, Statement by the President of the Russian Federation, 28 April 2025; Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Russian Federation, Foreign Ministry Spokeswoman Maria Zhakarova's comment on the liberation of Kursk, 26 April 2025

44 Institute for the Study of War, Interactive map: Ukraine's incursion into Kursk Oblast, 1 August 2025 and Harvard Kennedy School, Belfer Center for Science and International Affairs, Russia Matters: The Russia-Ukraine War Report Card, 20 August 2025

45 "Ukraine's army escapes from Kursk by the skin of its teeth", The Economist, 17 March 2025

46 "Russia and North Korea: A growing strategic partnership", 38 North, 17 November 2023 and Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, DPRK-Russia ballistic missile transfers: joint statement, 12 January 2024. See also "North Korean weapons are killing Ukrainians: the implications are much bigger", BBC News, 4 May 2024

47 "North Koreans deployed alongside Russians in Ukraine, sources say", The Guardian, 10 October 2024

48 "Zelenskyy asks allies to act on reports of North Korean troops helping Russia", Politico, 23 October 2024 and Main Directorate of Intelligence of the Ministry of Defense of Ukraine, Facebook, 24 October 2024

49 Institute for the Study of War, Russian offensive campaign assessment, 5 November 2024

particular the agreement's mutual defence clause, in order to respond to the Ukrainian incursion into Kursk and provide legal justification for the presence of North Korean troops on the ground.[50] Neither the Kremlin nor the North Korean regime officially confirmed or denied the reports at the time. Speaking at the BRICS summit on 24 October, President Putin did not deny the presence of North Korean troops in Russia and went on to highlight the mutual defence provision in the Russia-North Korea strategic partnership agreement, saying "what we will do and how we will do it is up to us".[51]

Following Russia's declaration at the end of April 2025 that Kursk had been liberated (see above), President Putin issued a statement in which he acknowledged the "active" participation of North Korean soldiers in Kursk. He said that such participation was in full compliance with international law and "in accordance with the letter and spirit of the Treaty on Comprehensive Strategic Partnership between the Russian Federation and the Democratic People's Republic of Korea".[52] At the time of writing, it is unclear whether North Korea troops remain in Russia and continue to provide Russia with direct military assistance in the conflict with Ukraine.

2.9 Russia's economy is placed on a war footing

Russia's economy and defence industry have moved to a war footing and Russian defence and security-related spending in 2024 was expected to consume approximately 30% of government spending, rising to 40% in 2025-26.[53] Many analysts have suggested that the significantly increased levels of defence spending demonstrate that Russia is "planning for a long war in Ukraine".[54]

In its annual assessment of global military capabilities, the International Institute for Strategic Studies said in February 2025 that total Russian military expenditure had grown by 41.9% in real terms between 2023 and 2024 to US$145.9 billion, representing 6.7% of GDP. Identifiable defence spending in 2025 is estimated to reach 7.5% of GDP. In purchasing power parity terms (PPP), where pricing disparities between currencies are removed, the IISS

50 Institute for the Study of War, Russian offensive campaign assessment, 15 October 2024. The agreement was ratified by the Russian Duma on 24 October 2024 and by the Russian Upper House (the Federation Council) on 6 November 2024.

51 "At BRICS, Putin appears to say that North Korean troops are in Russia", CNN-News You Tube channel, 24 October 2024

52 President of Russia, Statement by the President of the Russian Federation, 28 April 2025

53 "Russian lawmakers back massive military spending increase", The Moscow Times, 26 October 2023

54 "Russia's 2024 budget shows it's planning for a long war in Ukraine", Carnegie Endowment for International Peace, 11 October 2023; "America's $61bn aid package buys Ukraine time", The Economist, 25 April 2024 and "Russia to raise defence budget by 25% to highest level on record", The Guardian, 30 September 2024

estimates that total Russian military expenditure in 2024 was $462 billion, more than the entire defence budget of European countries combined.[55]

3 International reaction

Russia's invasion of Ukraine in February 2022, and its subsequent conduct, was met with widespread condemnation.[56] The annexation of Ukrainian territory has been called illegitimate and a violation of international law. Investigations into possible war crimes committed in Ukraine, including by the International Criminal Court, are underway. In March 2023 the ICC issued an arrest warrant for President Putin for the unlawful deportation of Ukrainian children to Russia, which is a war crime under the Rome Statute.[57]

An "unprecedented" package of sanctions has been imposed on Russia by the US, EU, UK and other allies and partners around the world.[58]

NATO has moved to shore up the defence of eastern Europe with the deployment of additional ships, fighter aircraft and troops to the region.[59] Military assistance is also being provided to Ukraine by NATO allies, although NATO troops will not be deployed on the ground as Ukraine is a partner country of the Alliance and not party to NATO's Article V mutual defence clause. As a direct consequence of Russia's actions in Ukraine, Finland and Sweden have joined the NATO alliance.

Not all countries have been openly critical of Russia's actions, however, with many opting to maintain a neutral stance. China, India, and many countries in Central Asia and Africa have abstained in votes in the UN General Assembly condemning Russian actions and calling for the immediate withdrawal of Russian troops.[60] They have also refused to implement Western-led sanctions against Russia.

Over the course of 2025, and as part of US-led efforts to secure a ceasefire and long- term peace agreement (see below), the Trump administration has softened its approach to Russia and agreed to reset relations from their status under the Biden administration.[61] The overall shift in direction towards Ukraine by the US administration since January 2025 and the increasing

55 International Institute for Strategic Studies, Military Balance Blog: Global defence spending soars to new high, 12 February 2025

56 UN General Assembly, Press release, 2 March 2022

57 International Criminal Court, Press release, 17 March 2023

58 Sanctions are examined in greater detail in Library research briefing, Sanctions against Russia

59 NATO's response is examined in House of Commons Library briefing, NATO: Reinforcing its eastern flank, April 2022

60 There have been four votes in the UN General Assembly on the Ukraine conflict, in March 2022, October 2022, February 2023 and February 2025.

61 President of Russia, Telephone conversation with US President Donald Trump, 12 February 2025

divergence between the US and its European allies is examined in Library research briefing Ukraine and Russia: A shift in US policy.

4 Efforts to secure a ceasefire and peace agreement

President Trump made securing a peace agreement in the Russia-Ukraine conflict a priority for his administration. While initially suggesting that a ceasefire agreement could be reached within 24 hours, the Trump administration's special envoy to Ukraine, Keith Kellogg, said in January 2025 that the aim was for the US to broker an agreement within 100 days in office (by end 29 April 2025).

US diplomatic efforts so far have not achieved the results that President Trump initially hoped for.

Talks in August 2025

In August 2025, President Trump and President Putin met in Alaska to discuss the reset of US-Russian relations but also the potential resolution of the Ukraine conflict. It marked the first time that the two leaders have met in person to discuss Ukraine.

That summit meeting was followed by a series of meetings in Washington between President Trump, President Zelenskyy and several European leaders.

The talks have been presented as largely positive and a tentative step towards achieving peace. However, significant differences remain, including over territorial concessions and the need for a ceasefire, which may yet derail progress.

President Trump has been clear that the next step must be a meeting between President Putin and President Zelenskyy, which could then be followed by a trilateral meeting between all three leaders.[62]

At the time of writing, further talks between President Putin and President Zelenskyy have not yet been confirmed and there is some scepticism over Russia's willingness to meet at a head of state level.

The August talks are examined in further detail in Commons Library research briefing, Peace in Ukraine: What have the August 2025 talks achieved?

[62] Donald J. Trump, @realDonaldTrump, Truth Social, 18 August 2025 (accessed 20 August 2025)

The background to those talks is examined in the following Commons Library briefings:

- Ukraine and Russia: A shift in US policy April 2025
- Developments in Ukraine peace talks (April to June 2025), June 2025

1 Useful sources / suggested reading

- House of Commons Library collection, The Conflict in Ukraine
- Institute for the Study of War, Interactive map: Russia's invasion of Ukraine and Interactive Time-lapse: Russia's War in Ukraine
- Institute for the Study of War, Russian offensive campaign daily assessments
- Russian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Situation around Ukraine
- Russian Ministry of Defence, Reports on the progress of the special military operation
- Ministry of Defence, Official Twitter/X account. The MOD provides daily defence intelligence updates on the conflict in Ukraine.
- RUSI, Crisis over Ukraine and European security
- Chatham House, Ukraine forum
- Harvard Kennedy School, Belfer Center for Science and International Affairs, Russia Matters

Ukraine

This map shows the boundaries of oblasts (regions) in Ukraine. Their names are shown in white text. Major cities and surrounding country boundaries are also shown.

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